

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, cloudy, rain toward evening, high 53. **Tonight**, rain, tapering off late, low 47. **Tomorrow**, mostly cloudy, breezy, a passing shower, high 50. Weather map, Page B12.

VOL. CLXXIV . . . No. 60,385 © 2024 The New York Times Company TUESDAY, DECEMBER 31, 2024 Prices in Canada may be higher \$4.00

FROM EMERGENCY TO DEADLY CRASH IN FOUR MINUTES

KOREAN JET DISASTER

Early Questions Emerge
About Accident That
Killed 179 People

By CHOE SANG-HUN
SEOUL — Already 30 minutes behind schedule, the pilot flying the Jeju Air jet with 181 people on board was preparing to land at his destination in southwestern South Korea on Sunday morning when the control tower warned him about flocks of birds in the area.

Two minutes later, at 8:59 a.m., the pilot reported a “bird strike” and “emergency,” officials said. He told the air traffic control tower at Muan International Airport that he would do “a go-around,” meaning he would abort his first landing attempt and circle in the air to prepare for a second attempt. But he apparently did not have enough time to go all the way around.

Instead, just a minute later, the veteran pilot — with nearly 7,000 flight hours in his career — was approaching the runway from the opposite direction, from north to south. And three minutes later, at 9:03 a.m., his plane, Jeju Air Flight 7C2216, slammed into a concrete structure off the southern end of the runway in a ball of flames.

All but two of the 181 people on board were killed, most of them South Koreans returning after a Christmas vacation in Thailand. The crash was the worst aviation disaster on South Korean soil and the deadliest worldwide since that of Lion Air Flight 610 in 2018, when all 189 people on board died.

As officials race to investigate the crash, a central question has emerged among analysts: What happened during the four minutes between the pilot’s urgent report of a bird strike and the plane’s fatal crash?

Footage of the Boeing 737-800 landing at the airport showed it skidding down the runway without its landing gear deployed. As it hurtled along on its belly, engulfed by what looked like clouds of dust, smoke and sparks, it did not seem able to slow its speed before slamming into the concrete structure 820 feet after the end of the runway.

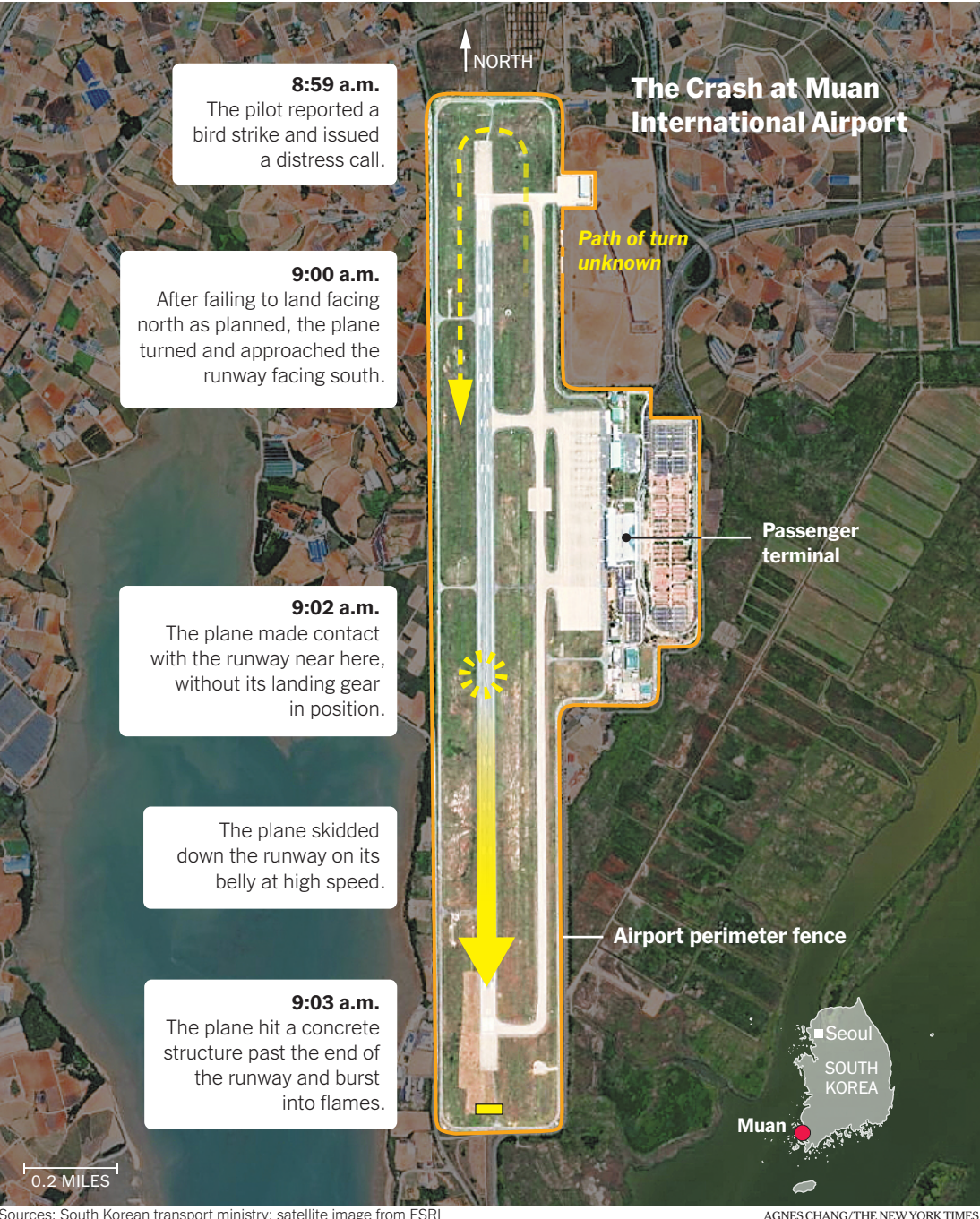
“A big question is why the pilot was in such a hurry to land,” said Hwang Ho-won, chairman of the Korea Association for Aviation Security.

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CHANG W. LEE/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Paying respects on Monday in Muan, South Korea, for those killed on Jeju Air Flight 7C2216.



Sources: South Korean transport ministry; satellite image from ESRI

AGNES CHANG/THE NEW YORK TIMES

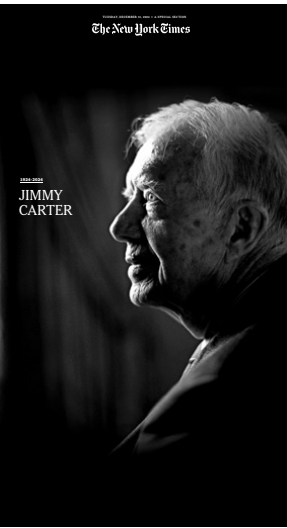
After a Presidency Ended, Carter Took On the World

A Mission of Service That Helped to Defeat Illnesses and Further Human Rights

By SHERYL GAY STOLBERG
WASHINGTON — President Jimmy Carter had no idea what he was going to do next when he delivered his farewell address to the nation in January 1981. Defeated after a single term by Ronald Reagan, he simply told Americans that he would leave the White House and “take up once more the only title in our democracy superior to that of president — the title of citizen.”
Forty-four years later, there is little question among historians that Citizen Carter carved a new mold for life after the Oval Office and that his post-presidency was the most consequential in modern history. But his effect was felt more strongly overseas than at home — especially in the realm of public health.
One of Mr. Carter’s biggest and most lasting post-presidential accomplishments is also one of the most overlooked: the near total eradication of Guinea worm disease, a painful parasitic infection for which there is no treatment or vaccine. In 1986, it afflicted an estimated 3.5 million people, mostly in Africa and Asia. There were only seven reported cases through the first 10 months of 2024, according to the Carter Center, Mr. Carter’s human rights organization [Page A16].
Mr. Carter first saw the devastating effects of the disease in 1988, in two villages near Accra, Ghana. “Once you’ve seen a small child with a two- or three-foot-long live Guinea worm protruding from her body, right through her skin, you never forget it,” he later wrote in *The Washington Post*.
Mr. Carter wrote books, 32 in all, and devoted his energies to advancing global health, democracy and human rights. He received the Nobel Peace Prize in 2002. He once said the world’s biggest problem was violence against women and girls, and he cited religious texts as a leading cause. He helped ensure free and fair elections in countries from Nicaragua to Nepal.
His personal diplomacy sometimes rankled. In 1994, with the assent of President Bill Clinton, he traveled to North Korea to avert a nuclear crisis, and then irked the White House by announcing a deal with the North Korean leader, Kim Il-sung, live on CNN. He visited Cuba and met with Fidel Castro, drawing criticism that he was a “shill” for Mr. Castro’s dictatorship. He infuriated Israeli and American Jews by likening Israel to an apartheid state.
Other former presidents have pursued post-presidential careers.

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SPECIAL SECTION



A full obituary for Jimmy Carter, the 39th president of the United States, who died on Sunday in Plains, Ga. He was 100 years old.

In Commanders in Chief Club, A Frequent Critic Was a Misfit

By PETER BAKER
When President Biden stopped by former President Jimmy Carter’s home in Plains, Ga., in April 2021, it was more than just a show of respect from one commander in chief to another. It was the first time in the 40 years since Mr. Carter left the White House that any of his seven successors had visited him in his hometown.
Mr. Carter had a hot-and-cold relationship with the fellow members of the exclusive club of presidents — more cold than hot, in fact. From his re-election defeat in 1980 until his death on Sunday, he was the odd man out, distant from the Republicans and Democrats who followed him and often getting on their nerves because of his outspokenness.
He did not join his fellow presidents on the high-dollar speaking circuit, nor did he team up for many joint humanitarian missions. He was rarely consulted by incumbents except when he forced his way into some issue and made himself hard to ignore. When all of the living presidents gathered to welcome Barack Obama to the White House in 2009, Mr. Carter was the one standing slightly off to the side, removed from his chummy peers physically and metaphorically.
To many of his successors, he was a thorn in their side, always doing his own thing even if it conflicted with official foreign policy. What he considered principled, they considered sanctimonious. While other former presidents

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DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

The living presidents in 2009, from left: George H.W. Bush, Barack Obama, George W. Bush, Bill Clinton and Jimmy Carter.

Shen Yun Needed Good Press. One Paper Always Provided It.

By NICOLE HONG and MICHAEL ROTHFELD
Steve Klett was so glad to have landed a job as a reporter at an up-and-coming newspaper in New York that he stuck with it even after his managers made him watch a disturbing video about the torture of a religious group in China.
Another reporter at the publication, *The Epoch Times*, found it odd that when she joined in 2022, her supervisor directed her to sit at her desk and read two 300-page books about the evils of communism.
But one of the strangest things about the workplace, former employees said, was its apparent obsession with a touring dance group called Shen Yun.
When Shen Yun was performing in town, employees were regularly given free tickets. Reporters were sent to cover the show and often huddled afterward in hotel rooms near the venue, working all night to publish stories. One former reporter recalled colleagues’ taking quick naps on the floor.
Alongside its regular news coverage, *The Epoch Times* has published more than 17,000 articles about Shen Yun since 2009 — most of them full of glowing testimonials from audience members, with headlines describing the show as “heavenly,” “incredibly touching,” “flawless” and “the most disciplined performance of any kind.”
The fawning coverage was not a product of quirky editorial judgment or an unusual commitment

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Social Media Companies Locked In Tug of War Over Free Speech

By CECILIA KANG and ADAM SATARIANO
President-elect Donald J. Trump and his allies have vowed to squash an online “censorship cartel” of social media firms that they say targets conservatives.
Already, the president-elect’s newly chosen regulators at the Federal Communications Commission and the Federal Trade Commission have outlined plans to stop social media platforms like Facebook and YouTube from removing content the companies deem offensive — and punish advertisers that leave less restrictive platforms like X in protest of the lack of moderation.
“The censorship and advertising boycott cartel must end now!” Elon Musk, the owner of X, whom Mr. Trump has appointed to cut the federal budget, posted on his site last month.

Trump Vows to Unleash Content and Europe Wants It Reined In

In Europe, social media companies face the opposite problem. There, regulators accuse the platforms of being too lax about the information they host, including allowing posts that stoked political violence in Britain and spread hate in Germany and France.
Mr. Trump’s return to the White House is expected to widen the speech divide that has long existed between the United States and Europe, setting up parallel regulatory systems that tech policy experts say could influence elections, public health and public discourse. That’s putting social media companies in the middle of

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Moscow’s Search for Conscripts
From murder suspects to immigrants to an Olympic gold medalist, Russia pressures men to fight in Ukraine. PAGE A10

Inside a Fentanyl Lab

New York Times reporters witnessed the dangerous production process run by the Sinaloa cartel. PAGE A4



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Musk Settles In at Mar-a-Lago
The billionaire has been staying at a \$2,000-a-night cottage at the Florida club, giving him easy access to the president-elect. PAGE A19

Fight Over Tribal Casino Plans
Three projects in California and Oregon are awaiting a final go-ahead from the Interior Department. PAGE A13

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Running Away From the Pack
Boise State’s Ashton Jeanty enters the College Football Playoff 131 yards shy of the season rushing record. PAGE B6

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A Battle With Schizophrenia
Early intervention tries to rein in disorders before they can ruin lives. For one man, everything is on the line. PAGE D1

Busy Winning Our Hearts
Nibi, below, a real diva of a beaver, and a pygmy hippo were among the animals who charmed us in 2024. PAGE D8



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Trump’s Agenda Stirs Worries
Small investors who are tempted to make major portfolio moves would do well to revisit 2020. PAGE B1

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Star on Broadway and ‘Alice’
Linda Lavin, a Tony Award-winning actress best known for starring as a waitress on a sitcom, was 87. PAGE B10

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The filmmaker Robert Eggers discusses his vampire tale, female desire and a maggot-infested actor. PAGE C1

Visualizing the Costs
The video game industry is learning that investing in realistic graphics may yield diminished returns. PAGE C1

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